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TRANSPORTATION



Rivian sues to sell its EVs directly in Ohio

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complaint. Tesla has had a license to sell in Ohio since 2013 and can sell directly to consumers.

What's stopping Rivian is a 2014 law passed by the state's legislature. That law, which Rivian says came after an intense lobbying effort by the Ohio Automobile Dealers Association (OADA), effectively gave Tesla a carve-out and blocked any future manufacturers from acquiring the necessary dealership licenses. (The OADA did not immediately return a request for comment.)

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Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

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“Consumer choice is a bedrock principle of America’s economy. Ohio’s archaic prohibition against the direct-sales of vehicles is unconstitutional, irrational, and harms Ohioans by reducing competition and choice and driving up costs and inconvenience,” Mike Callahan, Rivian’s chief administrative officer, said in a statement.

Rivian has won legal fights over direct sales before. In 2021, Rivian and Lucid Motors were granted dealership licenses to sell EVs in Illinois. That

state's dealer association sued to try to block Rivian and Lucid from selling directly but ultimately failed.

Lucid Motors, meanwhile, filed a lawsuit of its own in Texas in 2022 in a challenge to that state's direct-sales ban. The court ruled against Lucid earlier this year, but the company has appealed, federal court records show.

Topics: [Rivian](#) [Transportation](#)

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Tesla and Rivian charging networks have fewest problems by far,

according to Consumer Reports

Sean O'Kane — 11:38 AM PDT · March 18, 2025

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Electrify America, and ChargePoint didn't immediately respond to requests for comment.

Consumer Reports said that the most common reported problems across all networks had to do with making payments and with the charging station hardware itself — especially with the screens.

“By calling out broken screens, payment issues, and slow charging power, community members are crowdsourcing data that will hold charging networks accountable and improve drivers’ experience with public charging,” Consumer Reports’ campaign manager Drew Toher said in a statement.

Tesla has a network that it has plagued great new buyers, Superchargers electric

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What is a bit surprising is that Rivian is apparently matching Tesla when it comes to reliability, at least based on these respondents' experiences. That means it's off to a great start with [its first 100 stations](#). But it will be up to Rivian to maintain that quality as it attempts to build the other 500 stations it [has planned for North America](#).

Topics: [electric vehicles](#) [EVs](#) [Rivian](#) [Tesla](#)

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Sean O'Kane

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Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology of the...

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EV rivals Tesla, Rivian unite to target direct

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Tesla, Rivian, Lordstown Motors and Lucid Motors — potential rivals in the burgeoning EV market — are working together to pass laws that would allow direct sales in at least eight states with another batch of proposed legislation likely being introduced this year.

Passage of such legislation would clear the way for EV giants like Tesla, along with newcomers Lucid and Rivian, which have yet to bring a vehicle to market, to sell directly to consumers. However, Tesla's cooperation could also cost the company its monopoly on direct sales in some states.

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Tesla and a growing number of new EV companies have a different business model than legacy automakers like GM, Ford and Stellantis. Tesla sells vehicles through their own branded stores — similar to how Apple sells its products — and do not have franchised dealerships. The direct sales model has attracted the ire of auto dealers, who benefit from long-established rules in all 50 states that prevent manufacturers with existing franchisees from opening their own dealerships to compete with them. Tesla and other allies argue that because they don't have franchise dealers, they should be allowed to sell directly to consumers.

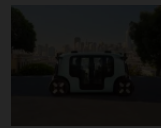
"We support our other EV-only manufacturers and their dealerships, but we don't want to create a precedent that would be allowed to other manufacturers," said Tesla, said a source familiar with Washington state's Department of Transportation. Protection of one of the most considered state.

Similar to Connecticut and Wisconsin,

these states ban all EV manufacturers from directly selling to customers; some only permit Tesla, at the exclusion of other companies, but cap the number of retail stores it can open.

It's a rare moment of cooperation for EV manufacturers, companies that must contend not only with each other but with legacy automakers for market share. Relations between the companies have not always been so copacetic: Tesla last July [filed a lawsuit against Rivian](#) alleging theft of trade secrets and talent poaching. Rivian responded that two of the three claims in the case were nothing more than an attempt to [smear its reputation](#).

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Kirsten Korosec
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Tesla is
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Michigan, home to major automakers GM and Ford, has been a longtime battleground.

Former Gov. Rick Snyder signed a bill in 2014 that was initiated and backed by the Michigan

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Lucid is leading the charge in some states where direct sales legislation is being considered, according to Daniel Witt, who worked at Tesla before joining the new EV entrant as a public policy lead. Witt emphasized the bills are the result of efforts from the coalition of EV companies, grassroots lobbying from EV owners and EV enthusiasts and consumer groups. The legislation has also found support from environmental and

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“Any situation where Tesla was at an advantage in negotiating with large companies and large corporations. Connected to the direction of the company.”

In a statement to TechCrunch, the Washington State Auto Dealers Association said franchised dealers support the transition toward zero-emission vehicles and want to sell them at their locations. But it said the direct sale bill is a “battle of Main Street vs. Wall Street.”

Rivian fires back at Tesla in lawsuit, accuses automaker of attempting to ‘malign its reputation’

Rivian has asked a judge to dismiss a lawsuit filed by Tesla, arguing that two of the three claims in the case fail to state sufficient allegations of trade-secret theft and poaching talent and instead was an attempt to malign its reputation and hurt its

“Electric vehicle manufacturers perpetuate [the] myth of the middleman when the reality is that they would bear the same costs if they built their own stores, but would ship their revenue to their billionaire investors out of state after the sale is made instead of reinvesting in the community,” the group said.

The organization pointed out that Rivian has garnered \$500 million in funding from Ford. Rivian, which is now valued at \$27.6 billion, has numerous backers, including Amazon, T. Rowe Price Associates Inc., Fidelity Management and Research Company, Coatue, Cox Automotive and D1 Capital Partners.

“What we need is a network for the owners of subsidia

It should express

EV man ahead of commit

the House and Senate before being sent to the governor’s desk to be signed into law.

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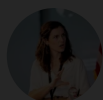
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Aria Alamalhodaie

Reporter, Space and Defense |

Aria Alamalhodaie covers the space and defense industries at TechCrunch. Previously, she covered the public utilities...

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